

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Standard English Conventions	Form, Structure, and Sense	Hard

Question

Recordings of electrical activity in the brain, _____ increased activity in brain areas associated with suppressing motor functions.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

Answer

- A. electrograms show that while responding to hypothetical match scenarios, the most highly skilled soccer players have
- B. the most highly skilled soccer players responding to hypothetical match scenarios have electrograms that show
- C. responses to hypothetical match scenarios show that the most highly skilled soccer players have electrograms with
- D. hypothetical match scenario responses show that the most highly skilled soccer players captured in electrograms have

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-modifier placement. This choice makes the noun “electrograms” the subject of the sentence and places it immediately after the modifying phrase “recordings of electrical activity in the brain.” In doing so, this choice clearly establishes that electrograms—and not other nouns or noun phrases in the sentence—are recordings of electrical activity in the brain.

Choice B is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase “the most highly skilled soccer players” immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the players are recordings of electrical activity in the brain. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase “responses to hypothetical match scenarios” immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that these responses are recordings of electrical activity in the brain. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase “hypothetical match scenario responses” immediately after the opening phrase illogically suggests that these responses are recordings of electrical activity in the brain.